RESULTS

On average, 58% of the sample approved creativity myths (see Figure 1, Table 1a and 2b). Benedek et al. (2021) reported seven statements with approval rates exceeding 50%; however, there were 11 such statements in this study (Table 1a). Furthermore, when the mean approval rates for each creativity myth were compared to the means for the Japanese and people in each of the six countries in the previous study (Benedek et al., 2021), "Creativity is a rare gift (Big-C bias: 68%)," "People have a certain amount of creativity, and cannot do much to change it (fixed mindset: 40%)" and "Creativity is essentially the same as art (art bias: 63%)" were higher than that of any of the other countries. These results are consistent with previous findings indicating the high prevalence of creativity myths, such as those linked to the Big-C bias, art bias, or fixed mindset (e.g., Agata & Okada, 2010; Ramos, 2005; Zhou et al., 2013). However, other myths with high approval rates besides those related to the Big-C bias, fixed mindset, and art bias also exist. For instance, the following were the statements that were approved more than those on the Big-C bias: "Creativity cannot be measured" (84%), "Brainstorming in a group generates more ideas than if people were thinking by themselves"(77%), "Children are more creative than adults" (77%), and "Creative ideas are naturally a good thing" (75%). These myths also had high approval rates internationally (Table 2a). The lowest approval rate in Japan was for the item "People get more creative ideas under the influence of alcohol or marijuana" (25%).

Table 1a. The creativity myths questionnaire and Japanese people's statement responses

		Incorrect	do not know	Correct	Approval rate	Uncertainty rate	Approval rate of Benedek et al. (2021)
Myth 1	Creativity cannot be measured	180	533	2112	0.84	0.09	0.58
	創造性は測ることができない	(6%)	(19%)	(75%)			
Myth 2	Creativity is essentially the same as art	463	1179	1183	0.63	0.21	0.39
	創造性はアートと本質的に同じである	(16%)	(42%)	(42%)			
Myth 3	Creative ideas are naturally a good thing	243	938	1644	0.75	0.17	0.59
	創造的なアイデアは本来、良いものである	(9%)	(33%)	(58%)			
Myth 4	Most people would not be able to distinguish abstract art from abstract children's drawings	620	1389	816	0.53	0.25	0.63
	ほとんどの人は、子どもの抽象的なお絵かきと、抽象絵画を区別することができないだろう	(22%)	(49%)	(29%)			
Myth 5	Creative accomplishments are usually a result of sudden inspiration	598	1166	1061	0.58	0.21	0.58
	創造的な成果は、通常、突然のひらめきの結果である	(21%)	(41%)	(38%)			

		Incorrect	do not know	Correct	Approval rate	Uncertainty rate	Approval rate of Benedek et al. (2021)
Myth 6	Creative thinking mostly happens in the right hemisphere of the brain	271	1945	609	0.56	0.34	0.54
	創造的思考は、主に右脳で行われている	(10%)	(69%)	(22%)			
Myth 7	Creativity is a solitary activity	753	1224	848	0.52	0.22	0.25
	創造は、孤独な活動である傾向がある	(27%)	(43%)	(30%)			
Myth 8	Creativity is a rare gift	486	834	1505	0.68	0.15	0.29
	創造性は、類まれなる才能である	(17%)	(30%)	(53%)			
Myth 9	People have a certain amount of creativity, and cannot do much to change it	1095	1216	514	0.40	0.22	0.19
	人がもつ創造性は一定であり、なかなかそれを変えることができない	(39%)	(43%)	(18%)			
Myth 10	Children are more creative than adults	282	761	1782	0.77	0.13	0.68
	子どもは大人よりも創造的である	(10%)	(27%)	(63%)			
Myth 11	Exceptional creativity is usually accompanied by mental health disorders	994	1341	490	0.41	0.24	0.40
	並外れた創造性は、たいてい、精神疾患と表裏一体である	(35%)	(47%)	(17%)			
Myth 12	People get more creative ideas under the influence of alcohol or marijuana	1647	946	232	0.25	0.17	0.43
	飲酒や違法薬物の作用で、より創造性の高いアイデアが得られる	(58%)	(33%)	(8%)			
Myth 13	Long-term schooling has a negative impact on the creativity of children	1013	1375	437	0.40	0.24	0.49
	長期間の学校教育は、子どもの創造性に悪影響を与える	(36%)	(49%)	(15%)			
Myth 14	Brainstorming in a group generates more ideas than if people were thinking by themselves	207	871	1747	0.77	0.15	0.80
	グループでのブレインストーミングをすると、一人で考えるよりも多くのアイデアが生まれる	(7%)	(31%)	(62%)			
Myth 15	One is most creative when with total freedom in one's actions	528	1322	975	0.58	0.23	0.70
	人は、完全に自由な行動をとれる時、最も創造的である	(19%)	(47%)	(35%)			

Note. Myths 2, 8, and 9 indicate art and Big-C biases, and fixed mindset, respectively

a creative breakthrough in a domain (i.e., publishing a successful novel) typically requires at least 10 years of deliberate practice and work" [38%]; and "Men and women generally do not differ in their creativity" [62%]).

Table 1b. The creativity facts questionnaire and Japanese people's statement responses

		Incorrect	do not know	Correct	Approval rate	Uncertainty rate	Approval rate of Benedek et al. (2021)
Fact 1	To be considered creative, something has to be both novel and useful or appropriate	543	1239	1043	0.59	0.22	0.46
	創造的と見なされるには、新しく、かつ、役に立つ（適切な）何かが必要である	(19%)	(44%)	(37%)			
Fact 2	Teachers appreciate the idea of creativity but not necessarily creative pupils	456	1121	1248	0.64	0.20	0.60
	先生は創造性を重視するが、創造的な生徒は必ずしも評価されない	(16%)	(40%)	(44%)			
Fact 3	Whether something is viewed as creative depends on zeitgeist and social norms	352	1052	1421	0.69	0.19	0.81
	創造的だと見られるかどうかは、そのときの時代精神や社会規範によって決まる	(12%)	(37%)	(50%)			
Fact 4	Creativity is an important part of mathematical thinking	511	1577	737	0.54	0.28	0.66
	創造性は、数学的思考の重要な一部である	(18%)	(56%)	(26%)			
Fact 5	Creative ideas are typically based on remembered information that is combined in new ways	297	1358	1170	0.65	0.24	0.83
	創造的なアイデアは、通常、記憶された情報が新たな方法で組み合わさったものがベースとなっている	(11%)	(48%)	(41%)			
Fact 6	The first idea someone has is often not the best one	982	1493	350	0.39	0.26	0.48
	最初に思いついたアイデアは、多くの場合、最良のアイデアではない	(35%)	(53%)	(12%)			
Fact 7	Alpha activity (10 Hz) in the brain plays an important role in creative thought	156	2132	537	0.57	0.38	0.61
	創造的な思考には、脳内のアルファ波(10Hz)が重要な役割を果たしている	(6%)	(75%)	(19%)			
Fact 8	Creative people are usually more open to new experiences	286	1212	1327	0.68	0.21	0.87
	創造的な人は、通常、新しい経験に対してよりオープンである	(10%)	(43%)	(47%)			
Fact 9	Creative people are usually more intelligent	703	1407	715	0.50	0.25	0.59
	創造的な人は、通常、より知的である	(25%)	(50%)	(25%)			

		Incorrect	do not know	Correct	Approval rate	Uncertainty rate	Approval rate of Benedek et al. (2021)
Fact 10	Achieving a creative breakthrough in a domain (i.e., publishing a successful novel) typically requires at least 10 years of deliberate practice and work	965	1558	302	0.38	0.28	0.37
	ある領域で創造的なブレークスルーを達成する (例：ベストセラー小説を出版する) には、通常、少なくとも 10 年間のよく考えられた訓練と作業が必要である	(34%)	(55%)	(11%)			
Fact 11	Men and women generally do not differ in regards to creativity	562	1020	1243	0.62	0.18	0.58
	男性と女性は、一般的に創造性に違いはない	(20%)	(36%)	(44%)			
Fact 12	A man's creativity increases his attractiveness to potential partners	414	1696	715	0.55	0.30	0.75
	男性が創造的であると、パートナーとなり得る相手にとって魅力が増す	(15%)	(60%)	(25%)			
Fact 13	When stuck on a problem, it is helpful to continue working on it after taking a break	131	464	2230	0.87	0.08	0.97
	問題につまづいた時には、休憩を挟んでから再開すると、効果的である	(5%)	(16%)	(79%)			
Fact 14	Positive moods help people get creative ideas	244	836	1745	0.77	0.15	0.81
	ポジティブな気分は、創造的なアイデアを生み出すのに役立つ	(9%)	(30%)	(62%)			
Fact 15	Getting rewarded for creative performance at work increases one's creativity	403	1178	1244	0.65	0.21	0.78
	仕事での創造的なパフォーマンスに対して報酬を受けることで、さらに創造性が高まる	(14%)	(42%)	(44%)			

Note. The Fact 1 statement shows the standard definition of creativity in the scientific findings, which is different from originality bias

Table 2b. Comparison of the approval and uncertainty rates of creativity facts in seven countries

	Japan		Austria		Germany		Poland		Georgia		China		USA	
	A	U	A	U	A	U	A	U	A	U	A	U	A	U
Fact 1	0.59	0.22	0.30	0.05	0.26	0.05	0.44	0.05	0.68	0.02	0.70	0.03	0.29	0.06
Fact 2	0.64	0.20	0.70	0.11	0.56	0.11	0.78	0.06	0.39	0.12	0.53	0.05	0.65	0.14
Fact 3	0.69	0.19	0.88	0.03	0.83	0.03	0.85	0.05	0.80	0.06	0.81	0.06	0.70	0.15
Fact 4	0.54	0.28	0.65	0.11	0.66	0.11	0.74	0.09	0.50	0.12	0.82	0.06	0.60	0.12
Fact 5	0.65	0.24	0.82	0.12	0.81	0.11	0.84	0.08	0.85	0.04	0.93	0.05	0.73	0.15
Fact 6	0.39	0.26	0.47	0.12	0.49	0.13	0.35	0.09	0.73	0.06	0.30	0.13	0.54	0.15
Fact 7	0.57	0.38	0.57	0.39	0.55	0.44	0.59	0.39	0.60	0.37	0.79	0.18	0.54	0.43